

Sony WF-LS900N

A hit and a miss

₹16,990

Sony has been actively working to increase its strong hold in the Indian audio market. And to plug the gap that was there in their lineup, between the 1000XM4 and the mid range price bracket, they have come out with the Sony WF-LS900N, priced at ₹16,990. With the design and specs similar to the flagship 1000XM4s, will the WF-LS900N be able to match up to the expectations set in the minds of consumers?

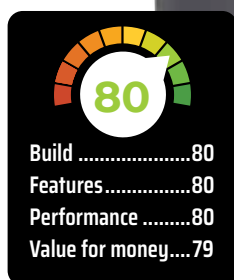
BUILD AND DESIGN

When it comes to the build quality of products, Sony has been a brand that has never let us down. And, when it comes to their latest launch, there are no compromises either. Sony's environmentally friendly recycled materials featured on their recently launched line of earphones have proven to be surprisingly durable. In the seven odd days where we were daily driving the earphones, the case picked up minimal scratches and scuffs. As for the buds themselves, they carry over the same material as the cases and underwent minimal wear and tear. They were lightweight, and comfortable to wear for extended periods of time.

FEATURES

The Sony WF-LS900N TWS earbuds come packed with plenty of features. Everything from ANC to the app worked flawlessly during our testing process. Sony's ANC in their flagship earbuds has become a benchmark for other players in the market to match up to. So, when you are using the LS900N, you can feel that it is from the same family of products. When in office, the buds cancelled out ambient sounds like that of the AC, and people's chatter in the background relatively easily.

The controls on these earbuds are basic and well executed. If you are someone who is coming from a different brand of earphones, then you might take some time to get acclimatised to the controls. The touch sensitive area on both



these buds was wide and sensitive enough to register our inputs. There were occasional misses, but that can be forgiven.

Coming to the app, it is the same as the one before. The Sony headphones connect app provides plenty of customisation options, along with an EQ that helps users customise the sound quality of the buds to their liking. The multi point connect and the swift pairing features of these buds were also flawless. Even when connected to an iOS device, almost all the features worked well, without any glitches.

PERFORMANCE

If you are spending ₹16,990, you would expect your earbuds to have an excellent sound signature, right? Well in the case of Sony WF-LS900N, it does not seem to be the case. We noticed the boosted bass and the underemphasised high mids during our daily use. So, to verify this, we put the Sonys through our test rig.

The bass is on the higher end on these earbuds. Especially, when compared to the Samsung Galaxy Buds Pro 2, the bass frequencies are much higher. And, when it comes to the higher mids, our suspicions came out to be true. The mids were a place where the Sony's performed beyond our expectations. The boosted bass might not be a problem for the bass lovers. But, for anyone else, it can get a bit overwhelming.

Same is the case with the underemphasised high mids. When these frequencies are underemphasised, what tends to happen is that the female vocals get suppressed. This also affects the day to day listening experience as well. However, if you are planning to rock out to the tunes of songs like Centuries by Fall Out Boy, you will experience almost no distortion at 100 percent volume.

For anyone looking for a decent overall audio experience, these buds are adequate.

BATTERY LIFE

When talking about the battery life, Sony WF-LS900N came fairly close to the claims made by Sony. With ANC turned on, and the volume set to 50 per cent, the battery on the buds lasted about five hours and ten minutes. And, with the case, the total went up to 19 hours, with some juice still left in the case.

As for the charging port, we get a USB-C port, which as per Sony's claims can provide 60 minutes of playback with just five minutes of charging time.

VERDICT

As a package, the Sony WF-LS900N, makes for a decent purchase. If you like Sony as a brand, and want a budget alternative to WF-1000XM4, then these are the buds you could go for. These buds are not flawless. If you are comparing these to the Samsung Galaxy Buds 2 Pro, the flaws in these buds come to surface. They retail at a slightly higher price than these earbuds, but still outperform the LS900N in almost every aspect. What we suspect here is that Sony did not want to step directly into the territory of their flagship buds. That is why they held back in making these as great as Samsung's offering.

All in all, if seen in an isolated bubble, these buds are decent. But, given the current situation of the earphones market, there are some better alternatives for sure.

—Sativik Pandey

SPECIFICATIONS

Weight: Approx. 4.1 g x 2 | Headphone type: Open, Dynamic | IP Rating: IPX4 | Frequency Response: 20 Hz–20,000 Hz (44.1 kHz sampling) | Battery Life: 5.5 hours | Bluetooth: 5.2 | Supported Codecs: SBC, AAC | Dimension: Approx. 41.4 x 48.5 x 30.9 mm

CONTACT

Phone: 18001037799 | Mail: Webform | Website: <https://www.sony.co.in/>